

Critique of dependency theory

1) Despite having the experience of colonial exploitation, some countries showed prominent economic growth.

Even though colonized countries experienced systematic exploitation over the years, we are not solely liable for their current poor economic performance. Countries like Japan, Vietnam, Singapore, Malaysia, Hong Kong showed prominent economic growth despite having colonial experience.

Therefore, blaming only blaming Europe for the poverty and poor economic structure of India, Bangladesh or African countries does not seem reasonable, that too after 70 years of independence.

11) Role of post-independent government

Post-independent govt could have taken proper policies to build a robust economic structure for sustainable economic growth. African countries could have taken advantage of their rich natural resources.

But most of the countries ended showed sign of heavy corruption, military dictatorship and ethnic conflicts.

Idi Amin, Robert Mugabe, Jacob Zuma are famously known for their high level of corruption, dictatorship and mismanagement. Some of the countries spent a significant portion of their budget on military spending while the people were starving.

Colonial exploitation can not be accused for these rent-seeking mentality, high level of corruption, military dictatorship, economic mismanagement or ethnic conflicts.

iii) Third-world leaders served the purpose of the west:

During the colonial era, ~~colonized~~ the land of colonies was used to produce cash crops.

But the post-independent leaders of the colonies were not bound to do so.

Still they did not prohibit food crops over cash crops and continued the same policy. For the sake of foreign currency they directed loans/subsidies towards cash crops and ended up being dependent on imported food for their

own consumption.

In Kenya, farmers in the cash crop sector got more help with loans, advice on pesticides and fertilisers, and crop care and efficient market back-ups more than those in the food crop sector.

In Socialist Tanzania, 80% of development budget went to large scale farming (which is more likely to be cash crops). In 1979-80

70.2% loans of Tanzania's Rural Development Bank (TRDB) went to parastatals and companies, whereas, farmers for small scale domestic food production received only 1%.

More Most importantly, all these policies were implemented by leaders of independent third world countries, not by colonial western colonizers.

These policies served the interest of the western MNCs. African cash-crops are source of raw materials for western MNCs, ~~that~~ ~~who produce raw materials~~. When third world leaders provide easy loan and subsidy for cash-crop production, it becomes easier for western MNCs to get cheap supply of raw materials and eventually accrue huge profits.

Moreover, the foreign

companies were not inhibited

iv) Dependency is multistaged fairly because of corruption

The dependency theory discusses the conventional dependency between poor countries vs. rich countries or ex-colonies vs. ex-colonial masters.

But dependency is multistaged. Dependency can exist in different form within a country.

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In colonial culture, labor and resources of colonies were used to develop the economy of colonial master.

The same practice is happening today ~~inside~~ in a different form ~~in a~~ inside a third world country. Where rural areas are treated as colonies to develop urban areas, specially capital city.

A classic example of this type of exploitation is power plant. Power plants are usually established by acquiring huge rural lands that involves forceful displacement of farmers from their own territory. The temperature near the region of power plant increases sufficiently and makes it unfavorable for crop production.

But most importantly, the benefit of power-plant does not go to the rural people.

A very small elite urban elite group enjoys the luxury of electricity at the cost of rural exploitation.

~~III~~ III

The relation of dependency also exist in an urban vs. urban form, where small urban companies are exploited by larger urban firms.

Moreover, there is dependency ~~between~~ in rural vs. rural form as well, where big money lenders or "mahajans" lend money to the poor villagers at extremely high interest rate.

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Thus, we can say, dependency is multistaged. And exists inside third-world countries in different forms.

Counter-critique (criticism of criticism)

We criticized post-independent govt for not prioritizing food-crops over cash-crops.

But, first of all, the system postindependent govt continued, remained untouchable for hundreds of years. It is not possible to switch the policy in a slash.

Secondly, West made their ~~sole~~ ex-colonies so dependent on them for various things (like loans, technology) that if the ex-colonies attempt to change one thing, they will!

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seriously penalized by the west in
some other way. Hence, if Africa do
not produce cash crops ~~for cheap raw~~
and supply them to the west, they could
~~be~~ ~~severely~~ severely suffer. The system can
not be altered without handcone revolution.